

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #019 — Phase 2, Film 4: Lead, Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

I WANT YOU BACK

LEAD: The Jackson 5 • RELEASE: Friday, July 31, 2015

Phase 2, Film 4 • The Guardians of the Galaxy role • Motown Productions / Paramount •

PG-13 • approx. 150 min

A. Why the Jackson 5

Guardians of the Galaxy is about a band of misfits from far outside the main story who become a surprise smash, powered by pure joy and a mixtape of hits. The Motown match is the Jackson 5, five brothers from a steel town in Gary, Indiana. Their first four Motown singles **all went to #1**, a record at the time. Their “I Want You Back” is on the real *Guardians* soundtrack (“Awesome Mix Vol. 1”), next to Marvin Gaye and Tammi Terrell’s “Ain’t No Mountain High Enough.”

Guardians of the Galaxy	The Jackson 5 (documented history)
Misfits from far outside the main story	A working-class family act from Gary, Indiana, not Detroit
Star-Lord, the charismatic frontman	Young Michael Jackson
Yondu, the harsh man who raised him	Joseph Jackson, their father and manager, whose strict and sometimes violent discipline his sons have described
The surprise smash	Four #1 singles in a row in 1970
The Awesome Mix	A string of pure-joy hits: “I Want You Back,” “ABC,” “The Love You Save” and “I’ll Be There”

Also considered	Verdict
The Funk Brothers	A perfect unsung-heroes story, saved for a full film of their own.
Rick James	His story belongs to a later era (from 1978), outside Phase 2.

B. Release Date: Friday, July 31, 2015

Guardians of the Galaxy opened on Friday, August 1, 2014. Exactly 52 weeks later is **Friday, July 31, 2015**, a late-summer release like the original.

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *I Want You Back*

It's the exact title of their first Motown #1 and the song on the real *Guardians* soundtrack. To the public, it's a song title (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Michael Jackson, <i>Moonwalk</i> (1988)	Michael's point of view as a child performer
Katherine Jackson, <i>My Family, the Jacksons</i> (1990)	The family in Gary and the move west
The master recordings, label credits, the Billboard chart record, and the 1968 audition footage	Every song, credit and chart position, and the audition itself

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: Five brothers from a steel town, pushed hard by their father, win talent shows across the Midwest and land at Motown. They become the biggest new act in America almost overnight.

Act One: Gary (1965–1967). A small house in Gary, Indiana, and a father who rehearses his sons relentlessly. They win talent shows, play Chicago's Regal Theater, and win Amateur Night at the Apollo.

Act Two: The Audition (1968–1969). Singer Bobby Taylor brings them to Motown. They audition at Hitsville (July 1968), and Gordy signs them. The film credits Bobby Taylor accurately, correcting the Motown marketing story that Diana Ross discovered them. They move to Los Angeles, where Suzanne de Passe helps shape the act, and they're coached for stardom. "The Corporation," a songwriting team that includes Gordy, writes "I Want You Back." They appear on *The Ed Sullivan Show* (December 1969).

Act Three: The Record (1970). "I Want You Back," "ABC," "The Love You Save" and "I'll Be There" all go to #1, the first time any group's first four singles did so. The misfits from Gary are the biggest new act in America.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

The Jackson 5's, with Michael as frontman, the way Star-Lord fronts the Guardians. Everyone is at full strength (No-Nerf). Following Memo #001, the story is handled with full respect and ends in 1970, telling the childhood story of their rise.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The pressure of the machine that made them	Their father's harsh discipline, as the brothers have described it, and the grind of child stardom. Joseph Jackson is shown as documented: the force who drove them to success and the source of their fear. It's handled carefully for PG-13.
Internal	A lost childhood	Kids working like adults, as Michael described in <i>Moonwalk</i> .

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	1965 to December 1970. The fixed points are the Apollo Amateur Night win, the Hitsville audition (July 1968), <i>Ed Sullivan</i> (Dec. 1969), and the four #1s (1970).
Where	Gary, Indiana; Chicago (the Regal Theater); Harlem (the Apollo); Detroit (Hitsville); Los Angeles; and New York (<i>Ed Sullivan</i>).
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Nine. It overlaps <i>Hitsville 3</i> (the move toward Los Angeles).

7. Standalone World-Building

The Jackson family's world: Gary's steel-town life, the talent-show circuit, the brothers' bond, and a family transplanted to Hollywood. The story is complete from Gary to the record books.

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in <i>I Want You Back</i>
Crossovers	The July 1968 audition at Hitsville, set up in <i>Trouble Man</i> 's mid-credits. Diana Ross and Gordy in Los Angeles, shared with <i>Hitsville 3</i> .
Returning	Gordy, Diana Ross, Suzanne de Passe and the Hitsville sets, with the same actors.
Seeds	Jermaine Jackson and Hazel Gordy meet here (they married in 1973). That family tie matters when the brothers later leave Motown.

9. Post-Credits Scenes: Two

Scene	What happens
Mid-credits (Los Angeles, 1969)	Eleven-year-old Michael dances alone to a playback of "I Want You Back." It mirrors Baby Groot's dance, to the same song.
End-credits (1971)	The brothers watch themselves as cartoon characters on Saturday-morning TV (<i>Jackson 5ive</i> , ABC, 1971). It's a comic gag, like Howard the Duck.

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 2, Film 4 of 6. Released July 31, 2015.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 60% serialized / 40% standalone (Phase 2 target).
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 150 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The audition matches <i>Trouble Man</i> 's mid-credits, Ross, Gordy and de Passe are played by the same actors, and the dates fit the master timeline.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a Jackson 5 biopic, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.